

GROWTH

A Journey Through Pain, Resilience, Healing and Becoming

Sir Rodney Wafula Simiyu

CONTENTS

Dedication

Acknowledgement

PART ONE: THE BEGINNING

Chapter 1: The Child I Used to Be — A Happy Beginning

Chapter 2: When Home Lost Its Peace — Family Conflict and Change

PART TWO: THE STORMS OF LIFE

Chapter 3: The Pain of Betrayal — Learning That Not Everyone Stays

Chapter 4: When Life Became a Struggle — Financial Hardships

Chapter 5: Fighting Battles Nobody Could See — The Weight of Life

PART THREE: HEALING AND DISCOVERY

Chapter 6: A Heart That Was Broken — Love, Loss and Lessons

Chapter 7: The Awakening — Discovering Who I Am

PART FOUR: VICTORY

Chapter 8: I Conquered — Becoming the Person I Once Needed

The Final Chapter: My Growth Continues

A Message to the Reader

About the Author

DEDICATION

To my family, my friends, and everyone who has been part of my journey,

I dedicate this book to you.

To those who loved me, supported me, encouraged me, challenged me, corrected me, prayed for me, stood by me, and even to those whose presence or absence taught me valuable lessons—I am grateful.

GROWTH is more than the story of my struggles. It is a reflection of the people, experiences, challenges, and lessons that have shaped the person I am becoming.

I dedicate these pages to my family and friends because I believe that our journeys are never meant to be lived alone. We learn from one another, grow through one another, and sometimes find the strength to continue because someone simply believed in us.

May these pages remind you that difficult seasons do not last forever, that mistakes can become lessons, that pain can produce strength, and that no matter how far life takes us, we can always grow.

This book is my appreciation, my reflection, my testimony, and my lesson to share.

To everyone who has been part of my story—this is for you.

With love and gratitude,

Sir Rodney

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

First and foremost, I give all glory, honour, and gratitude to God Almighty. Through every chapter of my life, He has been with me. In moments of joy and in seasons of pain, in times when I understood what was happening and in moments when I did not, God remained faithful. He gave me strength when I felt weak, hope when I felt discouraged, and the courage to keep moving forward. This journey called GROWTH would not have been possible without Him.

I am deeply grateful to my father, Mr. Nathan Wekesa, and my mother, Selina Simiyu. Thank you for being part of my journey and for the role you have played in shaping the person I have become. Life has many seasons, and through them all, the experiences we shared have contributed to my growth and understanding of life.

To Mr Harry Juma, Ms. Rose Peace, Ms. Samantha thank you for being part of my story. Family is one of the greatest parts of life's journey, and I am grateful for the memories, lessons, and experiences we have shared.

I would also like to express my sincere gratitude to my spiritual fathers, Pastor Eric, Pastor Nyongesa, and Pastor Evans Wachiye. Thank you for your spiritual guidance, prayers, wisdom, encouragement, and for the role you have played in strengthening my faith. Your words and example have helped me understand that some battles are won not merely through human strength, but through faith, patience, and perseverance.

To my family and those who have stood with me, I am truly grateful. Mrs. Lydia, Grandma Mary, Grandma Nora, Grandma Jane, Mum Jane, Sister Kadogo, Ms. Hope Vanessa, Mr. Elvis, Mr. Abel, Mr. Leon, Uncle Jeremiah, Bro Dalmus, and Ms. Belindah—thank you for being part of my journey. Each of you has contributed something meaningful to my life, whether through love, advice, encouragement, support, or simply being present at different moments.

To my dear friends, I want you to know that I do not take your presence in my life for granted. Mr. Charo Hamisi, Mr. Alex Mae, Mr. Praise Baraka, Mr. Evans Mule, Mr. Bleciours Osangire, Mr. Peter Kilalet, Mr. Enoch Opicho, Mr. Collins, Mr. Moses, Mr. David, and Mr. Emmanuel—thank you for walking different parts of this journey with me.

Some of you encouraged me when I needed strength. Some listened when I needed someone to hear me. Some challenged me to become better. Some brought happiness into difficult seasons, while others taught me important lessons through experiences that were not always easy. Whether your contribution was big or small, you became part of my story, and for that, I am grateful.

I also acknowledge the many people whose names may not appear on these pages but whose kindness, prayers, advice, support, friendship, and presence have touched my life. To the many more who have been part of my journey, thank you. You may never fully know the impact you have had on me, but I carry those moments with gratitude.

This book is not only about the challenges I have faced. It is about the people God placed along my path, the lessons I learned through them, the strength I discovered within myself, and the person I am still becoming.

To everyone who has contributed to my journey in one way or another, thank you for being part of my GROWTH.

With a grateful heart,

Sir Rodney

PART ONE: THE BEGINNING

CHAPTER 1: THE CHILD I USED TO BE

A Happy Beginning

Before I learned what pain was, I knew what happiness felt like.

Before I understood betrayal, I knew how to trust. Before I experienced disappointment, I knew how to look at people with innocence. Before life taught me about struggles, financial difficulties, family problems, heartbreak, and the unexpected turns that can change a person's path, I was simply a child happy, hopeful, and surrounded by people who cared about me.

When I look back at the child I used to be, I realize that childhood was more than just a period of growing up. It was the foundation upon which the person I am today was built.

I had people who cared for me. I had moments that made me smile. I had dreams that had not yet been challenged by reality. I did not know that life could sometimes become difficult. I did not know that people could change, relationships could break, families could go through difficult seasons, or that circumstances could force a person to become stronger before they were ready.

I simply lived.

I laughed. I played. I trusted. I loved.

There was something beautiful about being a child because tomorrow did not carry the weight it sometimes carries today, I could simply wake up yawn stretch and walk to the dining get forty shillings from dad go at mama Glory's shop take a loaf of bread come back home and be ready to startup by breakfast. A child's heart can find happiness in the smallest things, the small plays, silly compliments, little praises and more important the unending peace. A kind word can be enough. A familiar face can bring comfort. A simple moment can become a treasured memory.

And those memories matter to me. Just remembered this day I was bought a new pair of shoes on a Sunday night and I could not sleep, all I was waiting for was dawn to arise and shine on my way to school, finally morning came then as I had waited I took the breakfast as fast as possible then now it was time for the whole world to know latest new-shoes owner...boys and girls I present to you Rony the guy with new shoes.... as expected it was a triumphant entry in not only class one back at Foundation Academy – Kamukuywa but the whole school came to a standstill for me, that is one of my best childhood memories that won't ever leave my mind to

date.

They remind me that before the struggles came, there was joy, the joy of small wins mattered a lot, the joy of appreciation.

Before the battles, there was innocence.

Before I learned how to survive, I first learned how to live, live a genuinely fair and free life.

Some of the greatest memories of childhood are not necessarily about places or possessions. They are about people.

The people who cared for me became part of my foundation. Their presence, their words, their love, their corrections, and even the things I did not understand at the time would later become part of the story of my growth, the mothers present, the fathers, the friends both at school and at home, the kinds of Mama Glory, Mrs Busolo they ensured I was on track even in the absence of my parents, wherever they were around I felt safe at all times nothing to fear.

At that age, I could not have known how important those moments would become, I could have given them my all, my everything, I could have valued every minute and second.

I did not know that one day I would look back and realize that some of the happiest memories of my life came from a season when I had very little understanding of how complicated life could become.

I only knew that I was loved.

And perhaps that is one of the greatest gifts a child can receive.

Dreams Before Reality

Like many children, I had dreams, dreams that anytime I could tell mum she could look at me rub my head and just smile I guess it's because she knew the reality ahead, but all in all, she still gave me hope.

My imagination was bigger than my circumstances. I could look at the future without fear because I had not yet experienced enough of life to be afraid of it, I believed I could move mountains and oceans and surprisingly I had no doubts about it.

I believed things were possible.

I believed tomorrow would be better than those days.

I believed the people around me would always be there till eternity.

That innocence was beautiful.

But life has a way of introducing us to realities we never expected.

The child I used to be did not know what was coming.

He did not know that one day the peaceful moments would be interrupted by challenges. He did not know that family circumstances could change. He did not know that relocation, financial struggles, betrayal, personal battles, and matters of the heart would become part of his story.

But perhaps that was a good thing.

Because children should not have to carry tomorrow's problems today.

They should be allowed to be children.

And I was.

For a while, I simply enjoyed being the child I was.

Looking back now, I realize that those happy years were not wasted years. They were the beginning of my story.

They were the first pages of GROWTH.

And although I would eventually face seasons that would test me, the happy child I once was never completely disappeared.

Somewhere inside me, he remained—the child who knew how to hope, how to love, how to trust, and how to find joy.

Perhaps that is one of the reasons I survived everything that came later.

Because before life taught me how to fight, life had already taught me how to hope.

CHAPTER 2: WHEN HOME LOST ITS PEACE

The Day Everything Changed

It happened one day in January 2013.

I was still young, and at that age, there were many things about life that I did not understand. I knew my family, I knew my home, I knew school, and I knew the life we were living. I was used to having the things we needed and enjoying what, to me, was a happy childhood.

Then suddenly, everything changed.

My father, Mr. Nathan Wekesa, was interdicted from his job as a high school teacher.

As young children, my brother and I did not understand what an interdiction meant or what exactly had happened. We only knew that something serious had changed. From the way things unfolded, we guessed that our parents had quarrelled.

Then Mum took us to our grandmother's home.

At that moment, I don't think any of us understood just how much our lives were about to change.

A COMPLETELY DIFFERENT WORLD

Leaving our home was already difficult, but what made it harder was the change in our environment.

We had come from a happy life where we had the things we needed. Suddenly, we found ourselves living at Grandma's, where life was completely different from what we had known.

Even school changed.

We had been studying in one of the best primary schools in Kamukuywa. Then suddenly, we were transferred to a school that, in our young minds, felt like one of the worst schools we had ever known.

The change was so dramatic that my brother and I almost felt like we had become the best students automatically.

It was a completely different world.

The environment was different.

The people were different.

The language was different.

The lifestyle was different.

Everything seemed different.

And we had to adjust.

LIFE AT GRANDMA'S

Life at Grandma's was not easy.

There were many of us living together, and sometimes almost eight people had to share one very thin, one-inch mattress.

As a child, you don't always understand why you are experiencing certain things. You simply live through them.

Night after night, we slept in conditions that were completely different from what we had known before.

Then came another problem.

Jiggers.

We were attacked by jiggers, making an already difficult situation even harder. Life became uncomfortable, painful, and challenging.

I remember wondering why everything had changed so suddenly.

Why had we left home?

Why were we living like this?

Why couldn't things simply go back to the way they were?

I did not have answers.

I only had to endure.

THE DAY MUM LEFT

Then, after the first term, another painful moment came.

Mum left and went back to Dad, taking our little sister with her. Our sister was barely three months old at the time.

My brother and I remained behind.

We were told that we had to finish the academic year before we could return home.

To a child, that felt like the worst punishment imaginable.

Home felt far away.

The familiar life we had known seemed far away.

The people and surroundings we were accustomed to seemed far away.

And suddenly, we had to learn how to live without the comfort we had once taken for granted.

LEARNING TO SURVIVE

But something happened during that difficult season.

We began to adapt.

We had to learn the Bukusu language.

At first, it was another barrier between us and the world around us. But eventually, we started learning how to communicate in the mother tongue.

We learned to listen.

We learned to observe.

We learned to adapt to our surroundings.

We learned things we might never have learned if life had remained comfortable.

And perhaps most importantly, we learned how to survive.

The life we had known at home had allowed us to be free to mingle and enjoy a social life. At Grandma's, things were different.

We became more reserved.

We learned that you cannot always live exactly as you want.

Sometimes life forces you to adjust.

Sometimes you have to become stronger before you even understand what strength means.

WHAT THAT SEASON TAUGHT ME

At the time, I saw that period as suffering.

I saw the thin mattress.

I felt the pain of the jiggers.

I felt the separation from home.

I felt the difficulty of changing schools.

I felt the absence of my parents and the familiar life I had known.

But today, when I look back, I see something else.

I see a child who was being introduced to resilience.

I see a young boy learning how to survive circumstances he had never imagined.

I see lessons that comfort could never have taught me.

That season taught me how to adapt.

It taught me how to communicate.

It taught me my mother tongue.

It taught me how to live with less.

It taught me that life can change without warning.

And it taught me that even when circumstances change, you must find a way to keep moving.

I did not choose that season.

I would never have asked for it.

But I survived it.

And sometimes, growth begins in places we would never have chosen for ourselves.

THE BEGINNING OF A DIFFERENT ME

The boy who entered Grandma's home in January 2013 was not exactly the same boy who eventually left.

Something inside me had changed.

I had seen that life could be beautiful, but I had also discovered that life could be difficult.

I had learned that having everything you need today does not guarantee that tomorrow will look the same.

I had learned that family can go through difficult seasons.

I had learned that circumstances can take you away from what is familiar.

But most importantly, I had learned something that would follow me throughout my life:

When life changes, you must learn to change with it.

That season was painful.

But it was also one of the first places where my GROWTH truly began.

I did not know it then.

I only knew that I was trying to survive.

Today, I understand that I was also being prepared.

PART TWO: THE STORMS OF LIFE

STORMS OF LIFE

CHAPTER 3

THE PAIN OF BETRAYAL

> *“The wounds of a friend are faithful, but the kisses of an enemy are deceitful.”*

> — Proverbs 27:6

Some storms arrive with thunder and lightning, announcing their presence to everyone around us. Others unfold quietly, deep within the heart, where no one can see the damage they cause.

Betrayal is one of those storms.

It does not always come from an enemy. Sometimes, it comes from the very people we trust. Sometimes, the person who hurts us is the person whose presence we believed would make difficult days easier. At times, the deepest wound is not what someone said or did, but the realization that we never expected it from them.

I learned this lesson while I was still young.

Long before I understood the complexities of adulthood, I had already begun experiencing some of life's most painful lessons. My experience of betrayal did not begin with a major business deal, an adult friendship ending, or a dramatic disagreement.

It began at school.

It began with something I could not easily conceal.

My eyes.

THE FIRST WOUND

During my upper-primary years, I began experiencing problems with my eyes.

At first, people noticed that my eyes appeared unusually large. Later, they became red. To me, it was simply a condition I was experiencing. I had not chosen it, asked for it, or possessed the ability to change it by simply deciding to wake up one morning with different-looking eyes.

However, children can sometimes be cruel toward things they do not understand.

Some began laughing at me.

At first, I may have tried to ignore it. Sometimes, we laugh along with others because we do not want them to know that their words are hurting us. We pretend that everything is fine because admitting that we are hurt can make us feel even more vulnerable.

But there is a difference between laughing with people and laughing because they are laughing at you.

The laughter followed me.

What made it worse was that some of those involved were people I considered my friends.

That was where the deeper pain began.

If an enemy insults you, you expect it.

But when someone you call a friend joins those who are hurting you, something within you begins to question the meaning of friendship itself.

You begin asking:

Were they ever truly my friends?

Why would someone who knows me hurt me in this way?

Why would someone I trusted make fun of something that already made me feel insecure?

Those questions can remain with a person for a long time.

WHEN FRIENDSHIP BECOMES A WOUND

Friendship should provide a place where you can be yourself without constantly fearing judgment.

A true friend should know your weaknesses without using them against you.

A true friend may correct you, challenge you and even disagree with you, but should never deliberately humiliate you for entertainment.

That is why betrayal hurts differently.

It attacks trust.

The Bible says:

> **“A friend loves at all times.”**

> — Proverbs 17:17

This verse presents a beautiful picture of friendship. A friend is not present only when everything is going well. Friendship is tested when life becomes difficult or uncomfortable.

It is easy to call someone a friend when they are successful, confident, attractive, popular or thriving.

The real test comes when they are struggling.

I was struggling.

Instead of standing beside me, some people chose to turn my struggle into a joke.

Although I did not fully understand it at that age, I now recognize something important:

People sometimes reveal their character when they encounter another person's vulnerability.

WHEN YOUR WEAKNESS BECOMES ENTERTAINMENT

There are words people say casually and forget almost immediately.

Yet the person who receives those words may remember them for years.

A joke lasts only a few seconds.

The wound can last much longer.

One of the greatest dangers of ridicule is that the victim may eventually begin repeating the mocker's words internally.

Someone laughs at you because of your appearance.

You go home.

The laughter is gone.

But the voice remains.

Someone tells you that you are not good enough.

That person walks away.

But the statement follows you.

Someone makes you feel unintelligent because you struggle academically.

The classroom changes.

The lesson ends.

But the shame may remain.

That is how words can become invisible chains.

The writer of Proverbs understood the power of speech:

> **“Death and life are in the power of the tongue.”**

> — Proverbs 18:21

Words can destroy confidence.

They can also restore it.

This is why we should never underestimate the impact of what we say to others.

We may believe we are only joking.

The other person may be struggling to recover from the joke.

ALPHA ACADEMY — ANOTHER KIND OF PAIN

Then there was another struggle.

In 2012, at Alpha Academy Kamukuywa, mathematics became another source of difficulty for me.

I struggled with it.

For some people, mathematics came naturally. Numbers seemed to make sense, and they could look at a problem and immediately understand what was required.

For me, it was different.

I struggled.

When you are already carrying insecurity about your appearance, another weakness can feel like an additional burden placed on an already heavy load.

Struggling with mathematics did not simply mean that I was having difficulty with numbers.

At that age, it could feel as though I was struggling with my identity.

When people laugh at you because you cannot solve a mathematical problem, you may begin to believe that the problem is not the mathematics—it is you.

You begin to think:

Perhaps I am not intelligent.

Perhaps I am different.

Perhaps I will never be good enough.

When such thoughts are repeated often enough, they can become dangerous.

However, struggling with something does not mean that you are incapable of growth.

A weakness is not a permanent identity.

A difficult season is not a permanent destiny.

YOU ARE MORE THAN YOUR WEAKNESS

One of the most important lessons I would later learn is that a person's present ability does not always reveal their future potential.

The student who struggles today may become the teacher tomorrow.

The person who cannot speak confidently today may become an orator tomorrow.

The person who struggles with mathematics today may discover excellence in another field tomorrow.

The person being laughed at today may one day stand before the same world with a story that inspires others.

We often judge people by what they can do now, while God sees what they can become.

The Bible says:

> *“Do not despise these small beginnings.”*

> — Zechariah 4:10

Growth rarely announces itself.

A seed does not resemble a tree.

A cub does not resemble a lion.

A beginner does not resemble a master.

And a struggling child does not always resemble the adult that child will eventually become.

That is why we must be careful about judging people during their unfinished seasons.

WHEN THE EYES BECAME REDDER

As I progressed into high school, the condition of my eyes became more noticeable.

They were becoming redder.

Unfortunately, the mockery intensified.

Some people began calling me names associated with animals.

Those words were not harmless.

They were painful.

There is something particularly cruel about reducing someone to a name intended to make them feel less human, less valuable or less worthy of respect.

At that age, you are still discovering who you are.

You are trying to understand your identity and find your place in a world where acceptance matters greatly.

Then, suddenly, the people around you communicate—through their jokes and insults—that something about you makes you unacceptable.

That can severely damage a person's confidence.

But this is what I wish I had understood earlier:

Other people's opinions do not have the authority to define your worth.

People may misunderstand you.

They may mock you.

They may reject you.

They may abandon you.

But none of these actions changes the value God placed within you.

The Bible says:

> *“I praise you because I am fearfully and wonderfully made.”*

> — Psalm 139:14

That verse speaks to something deeper than physical appearance.

Your worth does not begin with how people perceive you.

Your worth begins with who you are.

WHEN FRIENDS BECOME DISTANT

Eventually, another painful chapter unfolded.

I relocated to a public school.

When I moved, some of my former friends cut me off.

There was no dramatic farewell or formal announcement.

Some relationships simply disappeared.

That is sometimes how betrayal occurs.

Not through a loud argument.

Not through a confrontation.

But through silence.

Messages stop.

Conversations fade.

People who once knew you suddenly behave as though they barely remember you.

You begin wondering what changed.

Was it the school?

Was it my circumstances?

Was it because I was no longer nearby?

Was I no longer useful to them?

Was I no longer part of their world?

These questions can be painful.

Relocation taught me another difficult truth:

Not everyone who walks with you for a season is meant to walk with you throughout the entire journey.

Some people are seasonal.

Some are present for a chapter.

Some are there to teach you something.

Others are present because you are travelling in the same direction for a particular period.

When the road changes, some relationships change with it.

That does not necessarily mean you failed.

Sometimes, it simply means the journey has changed.

THE PAIN OF BEING LEFT BEHIND

Being cut off by people you once considered friends can create a unique kind of loneliness.

You do not only miss the people.

You miss the version of yourself that existed around them.

You remember the conversations, the jokes, the shared experiences and the moments you believed those friendships would last.

Then, suddenly, you find yourself somewhere else, watching people who seem to have continued without you.

That can make you feel forgotten.

But being forgotten by people does not mean you have been forgotten by God.

The Bible says:

> *“Never will I leave you; never will I forsake you.”*

> — Hebrews 13:5

Human beings can leave.

God does not.

Human beings can change.

God remains faithful.

People may fail to recognize your worth.

God does not.

This distinction became increasingly important in my journey.

BETRAYAL DOES NOT HAVE TO MAKE YOU BITTER

One of the greatest dangers of betrayal is not the wound itself.

It is what the wound can turn you into.

You may become bitter.

You may begin distrusting everyone.

You may assume that every friend will eventually hurt you.

You may build walls so high that even good people cannot reach you.

You may become the very kind of person who once hurt you.

That is another battle.

The goal of healing is not merely to stop hurting.

The goal is to prevent the hurt from controlling who you become.

Nelson Mandela is often associated with the idea that resentment can imprison the person carrying it. Whether or not every popular version of that quotation is exact, the principle remains powerful: holding onto anger can keep us psychologically tied to the people who hurt us.

Forgiveness, therefore, does not necessarily mean declaring that what happened was acceptable.

Forgiveness can mean refusing to allow yesterday's wound to control tomorrow's life.

Jesus provided an extraordinary example of forgiveness when He prayed for those who were crucifying Him:

> **“Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing.”**

> — Luke 23:34

That is an extraordinary standard.

It reminds us that forgiveness is not weakness.

Sometimes, forgiveness is one of the strongest choices a wounded person can make.

WHAT BETRAYAL TAUGHT ME

Looking back, I can now see that those experiences were teaching me lessons I could not understand at the time.

The laughter taught me empathy.

The rejection taught me resilience.

The academic struggles taught me humility.

The insults taught me that words matter.

The loss of friendships taught me that not everyone who enters your life is meant to remain forever.

Betrayal taught me to be more discerning about where I placed my trust.

I began to understand that friendship should not be measured only by how much enjoyment you share.

It should also be measured by how safe you feel when you are vulnerable.

A genuine friend should not require you to be perfect.

A genuine friend should be able to see your weaknesses without turning them into weapons.

A genuine friend does not celebrate your embarrassment.

A genuine friend does not disappear simply because your circumstances change.

A genuine friend does not require you to become someone else before valuing you.

SOMETIMES THE STORM REVEALS THE PEOPLE

Storms have a remarkable way of revealing things.

When the weather is calm, almost anyone can stand beside you.

When the storm arrives, you discover who is willing to remain.

The same is true in life.

When everything is working, people may surround you.

When you have money, opportunities, popularity and confidence, friendship can appear easy.

But when your circumstances change, when you struggle, when your appearance changes, when you fail, when you move elsewhere, or when you have nothing impressive to offer, you begin to discover who genuinely values you.

That is why storms can be painful but also revealing.

They expose relationships.

They expose motives.

They expose character.

Sometimes, they also expose aspects of ourselves that need to grow.

I WAS NOT MY EYES

For years, I could have allowed the condition of my eyes to define who I was.

I could have allowed the jokes to become my identity.

I could have allowed my struggles in mathematics to convince me that I was unintelligent.

I could have allowed the rejection from former friends to convince me that I was unworthy of friendship.

Eventually, however, I had to confront a deeper truth:

I was more than what people saw.

I was more than my eyes.

I was more than my academic struggles.

I was more than my financial circumstances.

I was more than the names people called me.

I was more than the friendships I lost.

Perhaps that is one of the greatest lessons of growth:

You must learn to separate who you are from what happened to you.

Something happened to you.

That does not mean it has to become you.

People hurt you.

That does not mean you have to become hurtful.

People rejected you.

That does not mean you have to reject yourself.

People laughed at you.

That does not mean you have to laugh at your own potential.

People walked away.

That does not mean your journey has ended.

FROM WOUND TO WISDOM

There is a difference between remembering your pain and living within it.

I remember those years.

I remember the laughter.

I remember the comments.

I remember struggling with mathematics.

I remember the pain of being mocked because of my eyes.

I remember how it felt when people I considered friends eventually became distant.

But I do not want to remember those experiences only as evidence of what went wrong.

I want to remember them as evidence of what I survived.

That is the transformation.

The story does not end with:

“They laughed at me.”

It continues:

“They laughed at me, but I kept going.”

It does not end with:

“They rejected me.”

It continues:

“They rejected me, but I discovered that rejection could not determine my destiny.”

It does not end with:

“I struggled.”

It continues:

“I struggled, and I grew.”

It does not end with:

“They left.”

It continues:

“They left, but God remained, and I continued walking.”

That is growth.

THE PEOPLE WHO HURT US CAN STILL TEACH US

This does not mean that I am grateful for the cruelty itself.

Cruelty is not good.

Mockery is not kindness.

Betrayal is not friendship.

However, I can be grateful for what I learned through those experiences.

There is a difference between being grateful for the wound and being grateful for the wisdom that came from surviving it.

The Apostle Paul wrote:

> **“We know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him.”**

> — Romans 8:28

The verse does not say that everything that happens is good.

Some experiences hurt.

Some are unfair.

Some should never have happened.

But God can take even painful experiences and weave them into something meaningful.

The chapter that once made you cry can eventually become the chapter that gives someone else courage.

The insult that once damaged your confidence can eventually become part of the testimony that restores someone else's confidence.

The rejection that once made you feel worthless can eventually teach you how to value yourself.

The betrayal that once made you question friendship can eventually teach you what genuine friendship looks like.

TO THE PERSON WHO HAS BEEN BETRAYED

Perhaps, as you read this, you are remembering someone.

Someone who laughed at you.

Someone who exposed your weakness.

Someone you trusted who betrayed you.

Someone who disappeared when you needed them.

Someone who made you feel unwanted.

Someone who made you feel as though you were not enough.

If that is your story, I want you to understand something:

What they did to you is not the final definition of who you are.

You may have been rejected, but you are not rejected by God.

You may have been mocked, but you are not a joke.

You may have failed, but you are not a failure.

You may have been abandoned, but you are not alone.

You may have been betrayed, but you are not beyond repair.

Your story is still being written.

Sometimes, the most beautiful chapters of a person's life are written after the chapters they believed would destroy them.

THE STORM WILL NOT LAST FOREVER

Storms have seasons.

They come.

They remain for a while.

Eventually, they pass.

The child who was once mocked grows.

The student who struggled learns.

The person who was rejected finds new people.

The wounded heart begins to heal.

The person who once wondered, "Why me?" eventually begins asking a different question:

"What can I become because I survived this?"

That question changes everything.

Growth begins when we stop allowing our past to have the final word.

My childhood experiences did not disappear.

They became part of my story.

Today, I can look back at the boy who was laughed at because of his eyes, the boy who struggled with mathematics, and the boy who experienced rejection and betrayal, and tell him:

You were never as small as they made you feel.

You were growing.

You simply could not see it yet.

Like a seed beneath the soil, much of your development was taking place where no one could see it.

Perhaps that is the mystery of growth:

Sometimes the greatest transformation is taking place during the very season when you feel as though nothing is happening.

LESSONS FROM THE STORM

Betrayal taught me several lessons that I carry with me.

1. Not everyone who calls themselves your friend is truly your friend.

Friendship is tested by loyalty, especially when you are vulnerable.

2. Never allow another person's opinion to become your identity.

People see the outside. God sees the whole person.

3. Your weakness today does not determine your potential tomorrow.

Struggling with something is not the same as being incapable.

4. Rejection can redirect your life.

Sometimes, losing people creates space for new relationships, environments and opportunities.

5. Forgiveness protects your future.

You cannot change what someone did yesterday, but you can decide what you will carry into tomorrow.

6. Storms reveal people.

Some people disappear during difficult seasons. Others become stronger friends. Learn the difference.

7. Your story can become someone else's strength.

The pain you survive can become wisdom that helps another person survive their own storm.

FINAL REFLECTION

There was a time when I thought the people who laughed at me were simply making fun of my eyes.

Today, I understand that those experiences were teaching me something much deeper about humanity, friendship, identity and resilience.

I learned that people can hurt you.

I learned that friends can disappoint you.

I learned that circumstances can change.

CHAPTER 4

WHEN LIFE BECOMES A STRUGGLE

«“Though he may stumble, he will not fall, for the LORD upholds him with his hand.”

— Psalm 37:24»

There are seasons in life when you begin to wonder whether one challenge has to be followed by another.

You overcome one problem, only to discover another waiting for you.

You finish one difficult season, only to enter another that seems even harder.

Sometimes, life does not give you enough time to recover before the next storm arrives.

That was my experience.

Looking back, I realize that some of the most important lessons of my life were not taught in classrooms. They were taught by difficult circumstances.

Poverty taught me.

Failure taught me.

Pressure taught me.

Disappointment taught me.

Debt taught my family difficult lessons.

School struggles taught me resilience.

And uncertainty taught me faith.

There was a season when life seemed determined to test how much I could endure.

But somewhere within those struggles, I began discovering something I did not understand at the beginning:

Sometimes, struggle is not the end of your story. Sometimes, struggle is where your strength is being built.

THE STRUGGLE BEGINS

In 2016, I experienced one of my first major academic disappointments.

My performance in the KCPE examinations was not what I had hoped for.

I scored 301 marks.

For a young student, such a result can feel like a verdict.

You begin comparing yourself with others.

You hear about friends who have performed better.

You see people celebrating their results.

And somewhere inside you, you begin asking yourself whether you are capable of doing better.

I knew I had potential, but at that point, potential did not seem to mean much.

Then something changed.

A friend came into my life and helped me improve my performance.

Through that support and additional effort, I managed to move from 244 marks to 301 marks.

That improvement taught me something important:

Sometimes you do not need someone to carry you; you need someone who believes enough in you to help you carry yourself.

There are moments when one person's encouragement can change the direction of another person's life.

The Bible says:

«“Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor.”

— Ecclesiastes 4:9»

That friend became part of my story at a time when I needed someone to remind me that improvement was possible.

But even with the improvement, my father looked at the result and felt that it was still not enough.

At the time, I did not fully understand the pressure he was carrying.

Parents sometimes look at results through the lens of the sacrifices they have made.

They see school fees.

They see uniforms.

They see books.

They see food.

They see loans.

They see the dreams they have for their children.

And sometimes, when the result comes, their disappointment is not necessarily because they do not love you.

Sometimes, it is because they desperately want your opportunities to become better than theirs.

I was about to discover that academic pressure was only the beginning.

MY FIRST EXPERIENCE OF BOARDING SCHOOL

I was taken to a boarding school.

For me, this was a completely different world.

It was my first experience of boarding school, and unfortunately, the environment was not what I had imagined.

I was leaving the familiar environment of home and entering a place where I had to learn how to survive away from my parents.

Boarding school can be exciting when you have everything you need.

But when resources are limited, the experience can become completely different.

My father had borrowed money to make it possible for me to go.

My mother had taken books and uniforms on credit.

The sacrifices had already been made.

And then, within only two days, something happened.

Someone who came to me pretending to be a friend managed to swindle my 200 shillings pocket money.

Two hundred shillings.

To someone with plenty of money, it might sound insignificant.

To me, it was everything.

That money was supposed to help me survive.

My father had borrowed money.

My mother had taken my necessities on credit.

There was no comfortable financial cushion behind me.

And now even the little pocket money I had was gone.

That experience taught me an early lesson about trust.

Not everyone who approaches you as a friend has good intentions.

Some people see vulnerability as an opportunity.

Others see it as a chance to help.

You have to learn the difference.

WHEN SCHOOL BECAME SURVIVAL

Life at that school was not easy.

There was no luxury.

There was no variety.

There was little room for complaining.

Breakfast was often uji.

Lunch was githeri.

Evening meals were usually ugali with sukuma wiki or cabbage.

And the routine repeated itself.

Day after day.

For some students, Saturdays meant going home because their homes were nearby.

But my situation was different.

Home was miles away.

I could not simply wake up on Saturday morning and travel home like some of my classmates.

I stayed at school.

Sometimes, watching other students leave could make you feel even more isolated.

You knew they were going home to familiar faces, familiar food, familiar beds and the comfort of family.

You remained behind.

That kind of environment can either break you or begin teaching you endurance.

For me, it slowly began doing the latter.

I learned to survive without having everything I wanted.

I learned that comfort is not guaranteed.

I learned to appreciate small things.

And I learned that sometimes you simply have to keep going.

The Apostle Paul wrote:

«“I have learned to be content whatever the circumstances.”

— Philippians 4:11»

I was still young, and I certainly had not mastered contentment.

But life was introducing me to it.

I was learning to keep moving even when the circumstances were not ideal.

And despite everything, I finished that stage with 345 marks.

It was not the end of my journey.

It was another beginning.

CHESAMISI BOYS: A NEW BATTLE

My performance led to an opportunity to join Chesamisi Boys High School.

For many students, joining a secondary school is supposed to be a moment of excitement.

A new uniform.

A new environment.

New teachers.

New friends.

New dreams.

But my transition was far from easy.

When the time came for me to join Form One, my father was literally struggling financially.

He had to take another loan from a money lender to make it possible for me to report to school.

I eventually joined two weeks late.

Two weeks may not sound like much.

But in a school environment, especially in Form One, two weeks can feel like an entire world.

When I arrived, other students had already started learning.

They had already met their classmates.

They had already begun understanding the routines.

They were already settling into the academic environment.

I was arriving late, trying to understand everything at once.

I had to catch up academically.

I had to make friends.

I had to understand the school.

I had to adjust psychologically.

And I had to do all of that while carrying the knowledge that my parents were making enormous sacrifices just to keep me there.

It was overwhelming.

The first term became largely about preparation and trying to find my footing.

As a result, my performance suffered.

I finished among the lower ranks of my class, 376 out of 509 students.

That number hurt.

I knew my parents had sacrificed for me.

I knew my father had borrowed money.

I knew there were people at home working hard to keep me in school.

And now the results seemed to tell them that their sacrifice was not producing what they had hoped for.

My parents were disappointed.

And I was disappointed in myself.

WHEN SCHOOL FEES BECAME A FAMILY STRUGGLE

At Chesamisi, there was another reality I could not escape.

Whenever students were being sent home because of school fees, I rarely missed that experience.

It became almost normal.

The announcement would come.

Students would be reminded about fees.

Some would start preparing to go home.

And I would wonder when my own turn would come.

But the story behind those school-fee struggles was much bigger than me.

Back at home, money lenders were putting pressure on my parents.

The loans that had helped me get to school were now demanding repayment.

Eventually, my family had to make an extremely painful decision.

We had to sell our land to repay the money lenders.

Land is not just soil.

For many African families, land represents security.

It represents heritage.

It represents the possibility of tomorrow.

Selling it can feel like selling part of your future.

But sometimes, when circumstances become severe, people are forced to make choices they never imagined they would make.

We sold the land.

And we relocated to Likuyani, Kakamega.

Life became somewhat better.

It was not perfect.

But at least there was a little breathing space.

I had learned by then that life can force you to leave one environment and begin again somewhere else.

And sometimes, beginning again is itself a form of courage.

WHEN THE WORLD STOPPED

Just when I thought I had experienced enough disruption, another storm arrived.

There was a wave of unrest in schools.

Then came COVID-19.

The world seemed to stop.

Schools closed.

Learning stopped.

Movement was restricted.

Normal life disappeared.

We went home.

And what was supposed to be temporary became a long interruption.

We stayed home for about a year without normal learning.

For families with enough money, private tuition and other alternatives could provide some continuity.

But for us, that was not an option.

We could not afford private tuition.

So we waited.

Days became weeks.

Weeks became months.

And months became almost a year.

Imagine being a young person with dreams of becoming something in life, and suddenly the entire educational system comes to a standstill.

You do not know exactly when things will return to normal.

You cannot control the circumstances.

All you can do is wait.

That season taught me another lesson:

There are things in life you cannot control, but you can control how you respond to them.

The Bible says:

«“For everything there is a season, and a time for every matter under heaven.”

— Ecclesiastes 3:1»

There was a season for learning.

Then there was a season for waiting.

I did not understand why.

But sometimes understanding comes much later.

CHESAMISI BECOMES A BATTLEFIELD

When learning eventually resumed, I returned to Chesamisi Boys.

But school life was no longer what it had been.

The environment became increasingly unstable.

Strikes became frequent.

The school sometimes felt less like a place of learning and more like a battlefield.

Every time you thought things were settling down, another disruption could come.

For an ordinary student, this was already difficult.

For a candidate approaching the final KCSE examination, it was even more frightening.

I was supposed to be preparing for the most important examination of my secondary-school journey.

Instead, I was learning something else:

How to survive under pressure.

There were moments when I was at home because of strikes.

Think about that.

A candidate preparing for KCSE should ideally be in class, revising, asking questions, preparing for examinations and building confidence.

Instead, I could find myself at home because the school was experiencing unrest.

The circumstances were not ideal.

But somehow, I continued.

I had already learned something from the earlier storms:

I could not always control the environment, but I could control whether I gave up.

PRESSURE REVEALS CHARACTER

There is a reason diamonds are often used as symbols of strength and value.

Pressure changes things.

It can crush.

But under the right conditions, pressure can also produce something precious.

The same can happen to people.

Pressure can reveal what is inside us.

It can reveal whether we will surrender or adapt.

Whether we will complain forever or find a way forward.

Whether we will allow circumstances to define us or whether we will continue pursuing our purpose despite them.

Nelson Mandela's life provides one of history's clearest examples of perseverance under extreme adversity. His journey reminds us that difficult circumstances can delay a person's progress without necessarily determining the destination.

His famous words remain powerful:

«“It always seems impossible until it's done.”

— Nelson Mandela»

When I look back at those years, that statement speaks to me personally.

There were many moments when finishing seemed impossible.

But I finished.

There were moments when continuing seemed too difficult.

But I continued.

There were moments when circumstances seemed bigger than my dreams.

But my dreams survived.

THE LESSON OF THE 376TH POSITION

When I remember being 376 out of 509, I no longer look at that number only as a mark of failure.

I see it as evidence of a difficult season.

There is an important difference.

A result can describe where you were.

It does not necessarily describe where you are going.

One poor examination does not make someone a failure.

One difficult term does not determine an entire academic journey.

One financial crisis does not determine a family's future.

One season of struggle does not determine the rest of your life.

The Bible says:

«“The righteous falls seven times and rises again.”

— Proverbs 24:16»

Notice something about that verse.

It does not say the righteous never falls.

It says they rise.

That is the difference between perfection and resilience.

You do not have to avoid every fall.

You have to learn how to rise.

THE LOANS, THE LAND AND THE LESSON

Today, when I think about my father's sacrifices, I see things differently.

I remember the loans.

I remember the money lenders.

I remember the pressure.

I remember the land that had to be sold.

I remember my mother's sacrifices.

I remember books and uniforms being obtained on credit.

I remember the 200 shillings that disappeared.

I remember the school-fee struggles.

I remember being sent home.

At the time, I saw these things mainly as problems.

Today, I also see sacrifice.

My parents were fighting battles of their own while I was fighting mine at school.

Sometimes children see the struggle of the family but do not understand the struggle of the parents.

A father may be worried about debt while the child is worried about examination results.

A mother may be wondering where the next school fee will come from while the child is wondering why they are being sent home.

Everyone is struggling, but everyone is carrying a different part of the burden.

That realization has taught me gratitude.

THE FINAL TEST

My final years at Chesamisi were not easy.

Even as a candidate, unrest continued.

There were moments when I found myself at home because of strikes.

It would have been easy to become discouraged.

It would have been easy to say:

Why should I keep trying?

What is the point?

Maybe this is simply not my destiny.

But I had come too far.

I had survived the difficult primary-school years.

I had moved from 244 to 301 marks.

I had survived my first boarding-school experience.

I had lost my pocket money.

I had endured monotonous meals.

I had completed that stage with 345 marks.

I had entered Chesamisi two weeks late.

I had struggled academically.

I had experienced disappointment.

My family had borrowed money.

We had sold land.

We had relocated.

I had survived COVID-19 disruptions.

I had returned to a school affected by unrest.

At that point, giving up would have meant allowing every previous struggle to have the final word.

So I kept going.

And by God's grace, I finished well.

WHEN I LOOK BACK

When I look back at that season, I realize that the greatest thing I gained was not simply an examination result.

I gained endurance.

I learned how to continue when circumstances were not favorable.

I learned that sometimes success is not about having the best conditions.

Sometimes success is simply refusing to stop.

The world often celebrates people at the finish line.

It sees the certificate.

It sees the achievement.

It sees the final result.

But it does not always see the nights of uncertainty.

It does not see the school-fee problems.

It does not see the parent borrowing money.

It does not see the land being sold.

It does not see the student eating the same meals repeatedly.

It does not see the loneliness of staying at school while others go home.

It does not see the strikes.

It does not see the year lost to a global pandemic.

It does not see the candidate studying under unstable circumstances.

The world sees the destination.

God sees the journey.

And perhaps that is why the journey matters so much.

STRUGGLE WAS MY UNEXPECTED TEACHER

If someone had asked me during those years whether I wanted to experience those struggles, my answer would have been no.

I would not have chosen poverty.

I would not have chosen debt.

I would not have chosen academic disappointment.

I would not have chosen to arrive at school two weeks late.

I would not have chosen to struggle with school fees.

I would not have chosen to live through COVID-19.

I would not have chosen school strikes during my candidate year.

But life does not always ask us what we would choose.

Sometimes, it simply gives us a season and asks:

“What will you do with it?”

That is where character is formed.

That is where resilience is developed.

That is where faith becomes more than a word.

Faith is easy to speak about when everything is working.

It becomes real when everything is falling apart and you still choose to believe that tomorrow can be better.

The Bible says:

«“We walk by faith, not by sight.”

— 2 Corinthians 5:7»

There were many things I could not see.

I could not see how the school-fee problem would end.

I could not see how my academic journey would turn out.

I could not see how my family would recover.

I could not see what the future held.

But I kept moving.

TO ANYONE CURRENTLY STRUGGLING

Perhaps you are reading this while going through your own difficult season.

Maybe your academic performance has disappointed you.

Maybe your parents cannot afford what you need.

Maybe you have been sent home because of school fees.

Maybe your family is struggling with debt.

Maybe you are behind your classmates.

Maybe everyone around you seems to be moving forward while you feel stuck.

Maybe you have had to change schools.

Maybe circumstances have interrupted your education.

Maybe you are asking God:

“When will my season change?”

I cannot promise you that tomorrow will immediately become easy.

But I can tell you this:

Do not confuse a difficult season with a failed life.

A struggle is a chapter.

It is not necessarily the whole book.

Your current position is not your final destination.

Your present weakness is not your permanent identity.

Your delay is not necessarily your denial.

Keep learning.

Keep praying.

Keep trying.

Keep improving.

Keep believing.

And when you fall, rise again.

THE STORM MADE ME STRONGER

I once thought that a good life meant a life without problems.

Today, I think differently.

A meaningful life is not necessarily a life without storms.

It is a life in which you learn how to navigate storms without losing yourself.

Those years taught me that.

The struggle with KCPE taught me perseverance.

The improvement from 244 to 301 taught me that progress is possible.

Boarding school taught me independence.

Losing my pocket money taught me discernment.

The difficult meals taught me contentment.

School-fee struggles taught me the value of sacrifice.

My parents' debts taught me responsibility.

Selling land taught me that survival sometimes requires painful decisions.

Relocation taught

CHAPTER 5

FIGHTING BATTLES NOBODY COULD SEE

Some battles do not make noise.

There are battles fought in classrooms, in homes, in crowded places and even in the presence of people who love you. But there are also battles fought silently—in the mind, in the heart, and in those moments when you lie awake wondering what happened to the future you once imagined.

For a long time, I thought the hardest part of life was what people could see. I thought hardship was about lacking money, struggling in school, or being sent somewhere you did not want to be. But as I grew older, I discovered that sometimes the greatest weight is not what you lack physically. It is what you begin to believe about yourself because of what you are going through.

After Form Four, life took another turn.

I had finished school with an average grade. It was not the result I had expected, but when I looked at where I had come from, I knew it was better than some of the outcomes I had feared. Still, it was not enough to qualify me for direct university entry.

That realization was painful.

Around me, some of my friends were preparing to join university. They were excited about a new chapter—new environments, new friends, new opportunities. I was happy for them, but deep inside, something was breaking.

I remember seeing their photographs as they reported to campus.

One picture after another.

People I had studied with were now wearing their new clothes, carrying bags, standing in university compounds and celebrating the beginning of a journey I had also dreamed about.

I would look at those photographs, close my phone, and sit with my thoughts.

Then I would open them again.

Sometimes I wondered, Why not me?

It was not that I hated their success. I genuinely wished them well. But their happiness reminded me of what I had not yet achieved.

There is a special kind of pain that comes when you watch other people enter a door you have been hoping would open for you.

And sometimes, you begin blaming yourself for standing outside.

At the same time, life was changing socially.

People I had considered friends suddenly became distant. Messages became fewer. Conversations disappeared. The people I thought would remain close after school slowly vanished.

It was as though finishing Form Four had divided our lives into two different worlds.

They moved forward.

I remained behind.

Eventually, I realized that I had very few people left around me. My immediate family—my mum, dad, brother and sister—became the people closest to me.

And even though family was a blessing, the loneliness was still real.

I had to face the world.

I did not have a sophisticated smartphone to keep me connected to everyone. I had a simple button phone. At some point, even that phone died.

My brother had managed to proceed to a national school after Class Eight, and naturally, the family's financial resources had to be directed toward his education. There was nothing wrong with that. In fact, I was proud of him.

But somewhere inside me, I also understood what it meant for me.

I had to wait.

I had to find another way.

And waiting can be difficult when everyone else seems to be moving.

I began doing manual jobs.

There were days when I had to put my hands to work simply because life demanded it. I did not have the luxury of sitting around waiting for the perfect opportunity. I needed to survive.

But even in those jobs, I discovered another painful reality: people can easily judge you by the position they see you occupying.

Some people looked at me and assumed that because I was doing manual work, I had failed in life.

Others confused me with someone who had performed poorly in school and simply ended up working as a farm worker.

That hurt.

Not because manual work was beneath me, but because people were quick to define my entire identity by the work I was doing at that particular moment.

They did not know my story.

They did not know the struggles behind my grades.

They did not know the financial difficulties.

They did not know how many times I had tried to move forward.

They only saw where I was standing.

And sometimes, people take you for granted when they believe you have nowhere else to go.

I experienced moments when my effort was not appreciated. Moments when I felt underestimated. Moments when I wondered whether all the things I had dreamed about were slowly disappearing.

But somewhere beneath all that pain, something was happening.

I was becoming stronger.

Not loudly.

Not dramatically.

Quietly.

I was learning how to survive without applause.

I was learning that sometimes you have to keep going even when nobody is watching.

I was learning that a delayed opportunity is not necessarily a cancelled destiny.

Looking back now, I realize that those days were teaching me lessons that a classroom could never have taught me.

I learned humility.

I learned patience.

I learned the value of work.

I learned what it feels like to be misunderstood.

Most importantly, I learned not to measure my worth by other people's opinions.

There were moments when I felt like I was behind in life.

But life is not a race where everybody starts at the same point, receives the same resources, faces the same obstacles and reaches the finish line at the same time.

Some people get opportunities early.

Others have to fight for them.

Some walk through doors that are already open.

Others spend years building the door themselves.

And perhaps I was in the second group.

The hardest part was not the manual work.

It was fighting the thoughts that came with it.

"Maybe I am not good enough."

"Maybe I have failed."

"Maybe everyone else is moving forward while I am stuck."

Those thoughts were sometimes louder than the voices around me.

But I slowly began to understand something important: a difficult season is not a final identity.

Being behind does not mean being defeated.

Being rejected does not mean being worthless.

Being unemployed does not mean being useless.

Being unable to join university at the same time as your friends does not mean your education has ended.

And doing a humble job does not make your dreams small.

Life had taken a new turn, but perhaps I had not yet understood where that road was leading.

I only knew that I had to keep walking.

There were days I wanted an easier life.

There were days I wanted to have what my friends had.

There were days I wished I could turn back the clock and change certain things.

But eventually, I stopped asking, "Why is this happening to me?"

I began asking a different question:

"What can this season teach me?"

That question changed something inside me.

Because when you cannot immediately change your circumstances, you can begin changing the person who is facing them.

I started realizing that my story was still being written.

The chapter had not ended simply because I had not entered university with my friends.

My journey had not stopped because my phone was a simple button phone.

My potential had not disappeared because people underestimated me.

And my future had not been cancelled because I was doing manual work.

I was still growing.

Perhaps growth does not always look like success.

Sometimes growth looks like surviving another difficult day.

Sometimes it looks like waking up after disappointment and trying again.

Sometimes it looks like accepting that you are not where you want to be without accepting that you will remain there forever.

And sometimes, growth is simply refusing to give up on yourself.

That season taught me something I would carry for the rest of my life:

Never allow a temporary position to convince you that it is your permanent destination.

I was not yet where I wanted to be.

But I was not where I used to be either.

And even though I could not see it clearly at the time, the battles nobody could see were preparing me for a version of myself I had not yet met.

«“Weeping may endure for a night, but joy cometh in the morning.” — Psalm 30:5»

My morning had not yet arrived.

But I had learned to keep walking through the night.

PART THREE: HEALING AND DISCOVERY

CHAPTER 6

A HEART THAT WAS BROKEN

Sometimes, just when you think life has finally given you a reason to smile, it introduces you to a different kind of lesson.

After spending two years at home, I somehow found myself stepping into a place I had never imagined I would reach. Looking back, I can only say, God had a plan.

I had been at home for two years, wondering what would become of my life. Then, unexpectedly, an opportunity came. I found myself joining one of the universities I had never imagined I would attend—Mount Kenya University, Main Campus, Thika.

For someone who had watched his friends proceed with their lives while he remained behind, this was more than admission.

It felt like a second chance.

I was now a university student, studying ICT—a course I had never imagined myself taking.

There I was, walking through a university environment I had once only imagined from a distance.

Life was beginning to look different.

For the first time in a while, I felt that perhaps things were finally falling into place.

But university introduced me to another side of life.

Everywhere I looked, I saw people walking together—two by two. Couples laughing, walking around campus, sharing meals and creating memories. Sometimes I admired them.

I wondered what it would feel like to have someone who genuinely cared about me.

But honestly, I had no idea how to find such a person.

I wasn't searching desperately.

I wasn't even sure I was ready.

Then, unexpectedly, someone appeared in my life.

It started online.

We began talking, and somehow the conversations became more frequent. One conversation led to another, and before I knew it, something had developed between us.

We became a couple.

At that time, everything felt new.

She told me she was a university student somewhere in the Rift Valley and that she came from the coastal region of Kenya. I believed what I was told because I had no reason at that moment to think otherwise.

And then came the happy days.

We walked together.

We cooked together.

We gave each other gifts.

We talked.

We laughed.

We created memories that, at the time, felt genuine.

There are moments in life when you don't stop to question happiness. You simply enjoy it.

I was happy.

Perhaps that was why what came later hurt so much.

Because heartbreak rarely comes from someone you don't care about.

It comes from someone you trusted.

As time passed, I began noticing things that didn't make sense. There were other men in her life. At first, perhaps I tried to convince myself that I was misunderstanding things.

When you love someone, sometimes you don't want to believe what your eyes are showing you.

You give explanations.

You give chances.

You hope.

You tell yourself that things will become clearer.

But eventually, the truth has a way of finding its way into the light.

After about a year, I discovered something that shook me deeply.

The story I had been told from the beginning was not true.

She wasn't enrolled in the university she had told me about.

The person I thought I knew had built part of our relationship around a lie.

And then came another painful realization:

I was not the only person she was involved with.

That discovery did more than end a relationship.

It challenged my ability to trust what I had experienced.

I began looking back at all those beautiful moments and asking myself questions.

Were those moments real?

Was the happiness real?

What else had I believed that wasn't true?

Those questions can be painful because sometimes the hardest thing is not losing the person.

It is questioning the memories you once treasured.

I left that relationship broken.

I had entered it hoping to find companionship, but I left carrying lessons about trust, truth and the danger of building your heart around information that has never been verified.

I had opened my heart.

And it had been wounded.

But life wasn't finished teaching me.

Before I could fully recover from that heartbreak, another unexpected experience came.

At the time, I was in Nairobi doing my industrial attachment. I was trying to build my future, gain experience and take another step toward the life I wanted.

Then my phone was stolen.

It might sound like a small thing compared with everything else I had experienced, but at that point in my life, it felt heavy.

That phone represented more than a device.

It was my connection to people.

My communication.

My memories.

My small piece of convenience in a life that had already demanded so much from me.

And then, on my way back home to Thika, another difficult situation happened.

I was robbed and found myself without fare.

Imagine being somewhere away from home, having nothing to use to get yourself back, and not knowing what to do next.

Then, unexpectedly, a lady helped me.

She paid my fare.

In that moment, her kindness meant something to me.

Perhaps because I had already experienced disappointment, I was naturally grateful for someone who had shown me compassion when I needed it.

We eventually tried to build something between us.

Maybe I hoped that perhaps this time things would be different.

But again, things did not turn out the way I imagined.

The relationship became difficult.

There seemed to be differences between us—differences in our backgrounds and circumstances that made it difficult for things to work.

Then came the familiar explanations.

She was busy.

Life was demanding.

There were things happening around her.

Communication became less frequent.

The person who had once been present slowly became distant.

And eventually, I felt forgotten.

It was painful.

Not because I expected someone to owe me love, but because I had allowed myself to believe that perhaps I had finally found someone who would stay.

Once again, I found myself learning that not everyone who enters your life is meant to remain there.

For a while, I wondered whether there was something wrong with me.

Why did people come close and then disappear?

Why did I keep trusting people who eventually disappointed me?

Why did every attempt to find companionship seem to leave another scar?

But as I look back now, I understand something I couldn't understand then.

Not every loss is a reflection of your worth.

Sometimes people leave because of who they are, where they are in life, what they want, or what they are capable—or incapable—of giving.

Their departure does not automatically mean you were not enough.

That was one of the hardest lessons I had to learn.

I had spent years fighting external battles—school, finances, uncertainty and the struggle to find my place in life.

Now I was discovering that there were battles of the heart too.

And heartbreak has a strange way of making you question yourself.

It can make you compare yourself to others.

It can make you doubt whether you are lovable.

It can make you afraid to trust again.

But somewhere in that pain, I began discovering something important:

I could love someone without losing myself.

I could care deeply without making another person the foundation of my identity.

I could appreciate beautiful moments without assuming that every beautiful moment was a promise of forever.

And I could accept that some people would become chapters in my story rather than the entire story itself.

The Bible says:

«“Above all else, guard your heart, for everything you do flows from it.” — Proverbs 4:23»

For a long time, I thought guarding my heart meant refusing to love.

I eventually learned that it meant something different.

It meant loving with wisdom.

It meant knowing my value.

It meant recognizing that trust should be built, not blindly handed over.

It meant understanding that forgiveness and reconciliation are not always the same thing.

Most importantly, it meant refusing to let somebody else's actions determine how I saw myself.

Looking back, I don't regret every person who entered my life.

Some brought happiness.

Some brought pain.

Some brought lessons I didn't know I needed.

And perhaps that is part of growing.

We often imagine growth as gaining things—money, education, relationships, opportunities and success.

But sometimes growth is also learning how to let go.

Learning how to forgive.

Learning how to stop chasing people.

Learning how to walk away from what hurts you.

Learning how to sit alone without believing that you are worthless because nobody is beside you.

My heart had been broken more than once.

But it was still beating.

And as long as it was beating, my story was not over.

I began to understand that heartbreak was not the end of my capacity to love.

It was an invitation to understand love differently.

I had once thought that finding the right person would complete something inside me.

I was beginning to discover that I first had to become comfortable with who I was.

Before I could understand another person's love, I needed to understand my own worth.

Before I could expect someone to stay, I needed to learn how to stand.

Before I could build something lasting with another person, I needed to build something within myself.

That realization became the bridge between heartbreak and self-discovery.

The pain had changed me.

But it didn't have to destroy me.

It could teach me.

It could refine me.

It could make me wiser.

And perhaps that was the lesson hidden inside all those disappointments:

Sometimes God allows certain people to leave your life because your journey was never supposed to end where they left you.

I didn't know it then, but I was approaching another chapter of my life.

A chapter where I would stop asking only, “Why did they leave?”

And start asking:

“Who am I becoming?”

That was the beginning of my awakening

CHAPTER 7

THE AWAKENING

Sometimes healing does not arrive as one great miracle.

Sometimes it comes quietly.

It comes through laughter.

Through friendship.

Through discovering something you enjoy again.

Through learning.

Through conversations that last longer than expected.

Through people who remind you that life is bigger than the pain you are currently experiencing.

After the two heartbreaks, I realized that I could not continue giving all my attention to things that had already hurt me. I had spent enough time thinking about what I had lost, what people had done to me, and why certain things had happened.

I needed to find myself again.

So I began investing my mind in things that made me happy.

Football became one of those things.

Games became another.

They gave me something to look forward to. They allowed my mind to rest. Slowly, I began discovering that there was still a version of me that could laugh without pretending.

My industrial attachment had also taught me many things.

Beyond the technical knowledge, I was learning about the world, responsibility, people and myself. Every new experience added something to me.

But perhaps one of the greatest gifts during that period was not something I learned from a classroom or workplace.

It was the people who stayed around me.

I had people like Mr. Charo Hamisi, Alex Mae, Moka Nyange, Pastor Eric and Peter Kilalet.

Their presence mattered.

Sometimes I would call simply because I wanted someone to talk to.

We debated.

We laughed.

We discussed life.

We disagreed about things and continued talking anyway.

Those conversations may have seemed ordinary at the time, but they were helping me heal.

I began to understand that sometimes you don't need someone to solve your problems.

Sometimes you simply need someone who will listen.

Someone who will remind you that you are not alone.

Someone who can make you laugh when your heart has forgotten how.

Little by little, the pain began losing its grip on me.

I was not suddenly healed.

I was simply becoming less consumed by what had happened.

And then, unexpectedly, another person entered my life.

An online friendship.

Her name was Samantha.

But I came to call her Sammie.

I didn't know then how significant that friendship would become.

At first, it was simply another conversation.

Then another.

And another.

Before long, our conversations became something I looked forward to.

There was something different about her presence.

She brought a feminine energy into my life that, at that time, reminded me of something I had always found comforting in my family—the warmth I associated with my mum and my sister, Peace.

But Sammie was not simply someone who made me feel comfortable.

She challenged me.

She shared her own experiences with me.

She told me about the things she had gone through, the difficulties she had faced and the ways she had learned to keep moving despite them.

Listening to her changed my perspective.

I had spent so much time looking at my own struggles that I sometimes forgot something important:

I was not the only person fighting a difficult battle.

There were people carrying burdens I knew nothing about.

There were people who had every reason to give up but continued moving.

There were people who had been hurt and still found reasons to smile.

Sammie's strength in moving forward despite her own experiences became a game changer for me.

She didn't simply tell me to forget my problems.

She challenged me to look beyond them.

She encouraged me to focus more on my career.

She reminded me of the importance of family.

And perhaps most importantly, she began speaking into a part of me that I had not fully discovered yet.

She would tell me that I had the qualifications of a leader.

At first, I didn't completely understand what she meant.

A leader?

Me?

After everything I had experienced?

After the academic struggles?

After watching my friends move ahead while I remained behind?

After the disappointments, heartbreaks and seasons when I didn't even know what my future would look like?

But sometimes another person can see something in you before you see it in yourself.

Her words planted something.

I began looking at myself differently.

Maybe I wasn't a failure.

Maybe I was still becoming.

Maybe the difficult seasons had not destroyed me.

Maybe they had been developing qualities I would eventually need.

The child who had once experienced a sudden change in his childhood had learned how to adapt.

The student who struggled academically had learned how to keep trying.

The young man who watched others move forward had learned patience.

The person who experienced betrayal had learned that trust must be accompanied by wisdom.

The person whose heart had been broken had learned that losing someone does not mean losing himself.

And now, I was beginning to see that all these experiences had given me something.

Perspective.

Resilience.

Empathy.

Courage.

Perhaps even leadership.

I started understanding that leadership isn't always about standing in front of thousands of people.

Sometimes leadership begins with learning how to lead yourself.

Learning how to control your emotions.

Learning how to get back up.

Learning how to make decisions when nobody is there to guide you.

Learning how to keep your values when life gives you reasons to abandon them.

And most importantly, learning how to turn your experiences into something useful for someone else.

My friendship with Sammie continued to grow.

We discovered that our stories had many similarities.

Different circumstances, different details, but familiar feelings.

We understood certain struggles without needing long explanations.

We could talk about life and realize that sometimes the person on the other side of the conversation understood the pain you were describing because they had experienced something similar.

That connection became special.

But there was something even more important happening.

I was becoming a different person.

Not because someone came to rescue me.

Not because all my problems suddenly disappeared.

But because I had started participating in my own transformation.

I was choosing what deserved my attention.

I was choosing to learn.

I was choosing friendship.

I was choosing family.

I was choosing my career.

I was choosing to dream again.

And slowly, I was choosing myself.

That was the awakening.

I began to understand that healing does not mean returning to the person you were before you were hurt.

Sometimes healing means becoming someone stronger, wiser and more aware than the person you were before.

The Bible says:

«“Be transformed by the renewing of your mind.” — Romans 12:2»

I began to understand that transformation starts in the mind.

If I continued seeing myself as the boy who had failed, been rejected, been left behind and been hurt, then I would remain trapped in the past.

But if I could see myself as someone who had survived those things and learned from them, then the same history could become the foundation of my future.

My past had not changed.

But my interpretation of it was changing.

I stopped seeing every hardship as proof that life was against me.

I started seeing some of those hardships as experiences that had prepared me.

The friendships around me helped.

My family remained important.

My faith continued to guide me.

My career began to matter more.

And Sammie became one of those people who continuously reminded me that I had more inside me than I was showing the world.

She challenged me to dream beyond survival.

That was important because for a long time, survival had been enough.

When you have gone through difficult seasons, sometimes your biggest dream becomes simply getting through the next day.

But eventually, you have to move from surviving to building.

From asking, “How do I get through this?”

to asking,

“What can I build with the life I have been given?”

I began dreaming again.

I began thinking about the kind of man I wanted to become.

The kind of career I wanted.

The kind of family I wanted to build.

The kind of impact I wanted to have.

The kind of leader I wanted to become.

And I realized something beautiful:

I didn't need to erase my past to create my future.

I could carry the lessons without carrying the chains.

I could remember the pain without living inside it.

I could appreciate the people who had hurt me for the lessons they unintentionally taught me without allowing them to control my future.

I could love again.

I could trust again—this time with wisdom.

I could dream again.

I could become again.

And somewhere along that journey, I realized that I was no longer the person who had entered university carrying years of disappointment.

I was changing.

The boy who once wondered whether he would ever catch up with everyone else was beginning to understand that his journey did not have to look like theirs.

My timeline was my own.

My story was my own.

My growth was my own.

And perhaps the most beautiful thing was that I no longer felt like I had to prove my worth by becoming someone else.

I simply needed to become the best version of myself.

Sammie once told me I had the qualifications of a leader.

Maybe she saw something I was still learning to see.

Maybe that was one of the reasons our bond became so meaningful.

She did not only remind me of where I had been.

She kept pointing me toward where I could go.

And with her encouragement, the support of my friends and family, my experiences, my faith, and my own decision to keep growing, I began moving toward the person I had always dreamed of becoming.

I was not complete because someone else had entered my life.

I was becoming complete because I had begun understanding myself.

People could support me.

People could encourage me.

People could challenge me.

People could walk beside me.

But ultimately, the responsibility of becoming who I was meant to be belonged to me.

That was the awakening.

I had spent years wondering what life would make of me.

Now I was beginning to ask what I would make of the life God had given me.

And for the first time, I wasn't afraid of the answer.

I was ready to find out.

PART FOUR: VICTORY

CHAPTER 8

I CONQUERED

There was a time when I wondered whether I would ever become the person I dreamed of becoming.

There were seasons when life made me question myself.

There were moments when I watched other people move ahead while I remained behind. There were times when I struggled academically, financially and emotionally. I experienced betrayal. I experienced loneliness. I experienced heartbreak. I experienced being misunderstood and underestimated.

But somehow, through every season, I kept moving.

And today, when I look at the person I have become, I realize that perhaps my greatest achievement is not a particular certificate, position or possession.

My greatest achievement is becoming strong.

I have become the kind of person who believes that I can walk through fire and still come out standing.

Not because I believe life will always be easy.

But because I have learned that difficult does not mean impossible.

I have learned that I can face things I once thought would destroy me.

I can fall and rise.

I can lose and continue.

I can be rejected and still believe in myself.

I can be disappointed and still dream.

That is what conquering means to me.

It doesn't mean I have reached the end.

It means I have refused to allow the difficulties along the way to become the end of my story.

From knowing nothing to discovering what I could do

When I first stepped into ICT, I honestly did not know much about the field.

I had never imagined that I would find myself studying something that seemed so unfamiliar to me.

There were moments when I could have looked at what I didn't know and concluded that I wasn't capable.

But I kept learning.

I kept showing up.

I kept trying.

And something remarkable happened.

Despite starting without the knowledge I thought I needed, I have never had to retake an examination.

That achievement means more to me than the result itself.

It reminds me that sometimes potential is hidden behind uncertainty.

You may enter a room thinking you know nothing, only to discover that you are capable of learning everything you need to know.

The lesson was bigger than ICT.

I learned that not knowing something today does not mean you cannot master it tomorrow.

That became one of the principles I carried into other areas of my life.

Leadership found me

At one point, I became a class representative of a large class.

It may have looked like just another position, but to me, it represented something deeper.

People had trusted me to represent them.

The boy who had once struggled to understand where his own life was heading was now being trusted to speak for others.

That made me think about leadership differently.

Leadership isn't simply about having a title.

It is about trust.

It is about responsibility.

It is about how people feel when you are around them.

Even at home, I began noticing that people saw something in me.

Some began viewing me as a leader.

Some saw me as a game changer.

Some people seemed to find peace when I was around.

That last part means a lot to me.

Because I don't want leadership to mean making people afraid of me.

I want it to mean making people believe in themselves.

I want people around me to feel that there is hope.

I want my presence to bring peace rather than pressure.

And perhaps that is the kind of leader I was slowly becoming.

I learned the value of a small circle

Life also taught me something about friendship.

I no longer believe that you need hundreds of people around you to prove that you are loved.

Sometimes a small circle is enough.

I would rather have a few people who genuinely make me happy than a crowd that only appears when everything is going well.

My friends have been part of my support system.

They have laughed with me.

Talked with me.

Challenged me.

Encouraged me.

Some became more than friends.

They became family.

And that is something I treasure.

Because when life becomes difficult, you discover that the number of people around you matters less than the quality of the people standing beside you.

The light I didn't know I carried

Along my journey, Sammie became an important part of my growth.

She brought a kind of light into my life that helped illuminate parts of myself I had not yet seen.

Through our conversations, shared experiences and the challenges she gave me, I began looking at myself differently.

She saw leadership in me.

She encouraged me to focus on my career and family.

She challenged me to think beyond the difficulties in front of me.

Sometimes, another person doesn't give you something that wasn't already inside you.

Sometimes, they simply help you see what was already there.

And perhaps that is what happened.

I had potential.

I had dreams.

I had strength.

But I had not always recognized them.

The right people can sometimes hold up a mirror and help you see yourself clearly.

God was writing the story

Through everything, there is one thing I cannot leave out.

God.

God is my everything.

When I look at my journey, I see things that I could not have planned for myself.

I see doors that opened unexpectedly.

I see moments when I thought everything was finished, yet somehow another opportunity appeared.

I see people who came into my life at the right time.

I see strength that I didn't know I possessed.

And I believe God was nurturing me through every season.

Sometimes I wondered why certain things were happening.

Today, I don't claim to understand every detail.

But I believe there was a purpose even in the seasons I did not understand.

The Bible says:

«“For I know the plans I have for you,” declares the Lord, “plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future.” — Jeremiah 29:11»

That verse reminds me that my story has never been only about where I was.

It is also about where God is taking me.

The people who left eventually saw something

There is something else I have noticed along the way.

Some people who once walked away from me eventually began coming back.

Some began praising the person I had become.

That experience taught me another lesson.

Sometimes people don't recognize your value while you are still becoming.

They may only recognize it after the transformation becomes visible.

But I have learned not to live for their recognition.

I don't want to become great just so the people who left will regret leaving.

I want to become great because I owe it to the person I was capable of becoming.

Their return may be encouraging.

Their words may be appreciated.

But my worth was never created by their approval.

I had value even when they couldn't see it.

Becoming the person I once needed

Perhaps this is the greatest meaning of my victory.

I have become someone people admire.

I have become someone my family can be proud of.

I have become someone my friends can count on.

I have become someone who can walk into a room and bring peace.

But I don't want to stop there.

I want to become the person I once needed when I was younger.

The person who would have told me:

"Don't give up."

"Your current situation is not your final destination."

"You are capable of more than you think."

"Your story isn't over."

If my story can make someone who is struggling believe that tomorrow is still worth fighting for, then everything I went through carries an even greater meaning.

Because perhaps our greatest victories are not the things we achieve for ourselves.

Sometimes they are the lives we inspire because we refused to give up on ours.

I am still becoming

Today, I have dreams that are bigger than the dreams I had years ago.

I want to continue my education.

I want to write more books.

I want to grow beyond the limits I once placed on myself.

I want to become better in my career.

I want to lead.

I want to serve.

I want to create opportunities.

I want my life to mean something beyond my own success.

And I know I am not finished.

I am still learning.

Still growing.

Still making mistakes.

Still discovering new things about myself.

That is why I don't say, "I have conquered everything."

I say:

"I conquered what once told me I couldn't."

I conquered the belief that my past was my destiny.

I conquered the fear that my struggles were stronger than my dreams.

I conquered the voice that told me I was behind.

I conquered the temptation to give up.

And every new challenge I face will be another opportunity to grow.

To the person who is still waiting

If you are reading this while going through your own difficult season, I want you to remember something.

Don't kill a dream simply because you haven't seen it happen yet.

Don't bury something simply because its time has not arrived.

There are seeds that remain underground for a long time before anyone sees them.

The fact that nobody can see what you are becoming does not mean you are becoming nothing.

Dream.

Dream even when your circumstances disagree with you.

Dream when your friends are ahead.

Dream when people underestimate you.

Dream when you fail.

Dream when you have to start again.
Dream when nobody applauds.
And above all, never kill what has not yet had its chance to live.
Your time may not look like someone else's.
Your journey may not resemble theirs.
Your beginning may be small.
But small beginnings can carry enormous futures.
I know this because I have lived it.
I was once the child who simply wanted a happy life.
I became the student who struggled.
I became the young man who watched others move ahead.
I became the person who experienced betrayal.
I became the person who lost relationships and questioned himself.
But I also became the person who kept learning.
Who kept dreaming.
Who found good people.
Who discovered leadership.
Who found strength.
Who continued believing in God.
Who refused to give up.
And today, I can look at that younger version of myself and say:
“You made it this far.”
But I would also tell him:
“Don't stop here.”
Because victory is not the end of growth.
It is proof that growth works.

I conquered.

Not because I never fell.

Not because I never cried.

Not because I never doubted.

Not because life finally became perfect.

I conquered because every time life gave me a reason to stop, I found another reason to continue.

And the greatest victory is this:

I became someone I once needed.

My story is still being written.

My dreams are still alive.

My faith is still strong.

My journey is still moving.

And as long as God continues to give me breath, there will always be another level to reach, another lesson to learn, another person to inspire and another version of myself to become.

This is not the end of my growth.

This is only the beginning of everything I can still become.

THE FINAL CHAPTER

MY GROWTH CONTINUES

There are moments when I look back at my life and realize that I am a true definition of one simple truth: life always has a way of teaching you things you never thought could happen.

Some lessons came through happiness. Others came through pain. Some came through people I never expected to meet, while others came through people I never expected to lose. There were seasons I understood, and there were seasons I could only survive. But today, when I look at the journey as a whole, I realize that every season was shaping me.

I am a product of genuine people.

The man I am becoming was not made by my efforts alone. I was shaped by people who loved me, corrected me, supported me, challenged me, believed in me, and sometimes simply stayed when I needed someone around. My family, friends, mentors, and the people God placed along my path each contributed something to the person I am today.

And above everything else, I am a product of God's grace.

God has taught me to let Him plan.

There were times I thought I knew exactly where my life was supposed to go. There were moments when I believed that a closed door meant the end of the road. But life taught me something different: sometimes what looks like an ending is simply God's way of redirecting you.

God has a way of taking you through places you never imagined you would pass and bringing you beyond the point where you thought your story had ended.

I have learned that God is not human. His timing is different from ours. What I may consider late may simply be a different season in His plan.

And so I have learned not to give up simply because something has not happened yet.

WHAT LIFE TAUGHT ME

One of the greatest lessons I have learned is that nothing is permanent—not even the worst season of your life.

Pain changes. Circumstances change. People change. Opportunities change. Even the darkest nights eventually give way to morning.

That lesson has changed the way I look at difficulties.

When things are difficult today, I no longer automatically assume they will remain difficult forever. I have lived long enough to know that life can change in ways you never expect.

I have also learned to surround myself with people who add value to my life.

Not everyone who walks beside you is walking in the same direction. Some people teach you through their presence, while others teach you through their absence. Some give you money, while others give you knowledge, wisdom, encouragement, laughter, connections, perspective, or simply a reason to keep going.

There is more you can get from people than money.

Sometimes the greatest gift someone can give you is not what they put in your hand, but what they put in your mind.

I have learned to value genuine relationships, because some of the people who helped shape me were not necessarily those who had the most to give financially. They gave me something deeper: their time, their words, their belief, their friendship, and their presence.

I have learned that there is always light at the end of the tunnel.

You may not see it while you are inside the tunnel. You may even wonder whether the darkness will ever end. But darkness is not proof that there is no light. Sometimes you simply have to keep walking.

And above all, I have learned to dream.

A MESSAGE TO THE READER

If you are reading this book while going through a difficult season, I want you to remember one thing:

Do not judge your entire life by what is happening today.

I wish I could go back and tell my younger self this.

I would tell that boy to see beyond the present day.

See beyond today's struggles.

See beyond the marks you received.

See beyond the people who rejected you.

See beyond the opportunities you missed.

See beyond the doors that closed.

See beyond the days when you feel like everyone else is moving ahead.

Because sometimes the person you are today is only the beginning of the person you are becoming.

Your current situation may be real, but it does not have to become your permanent identity.

Dream even when your circumstances disagree with your dream.

Dream when people don't understand you.

Dream when you don't have the resources.

Dream when the journey looks too long.

Dream because you never know what tomorrow may bring.

My own dreams are still alive.

I dream of becoming Dr. Rodney Wafula Simiyu through learning. I dream of earning a PhD. I dream of becoming a CEO. I dream of becoming a great leader. I dream of continuing my education, writing more books, impacting people, and becoming more than the circumstances that once surrounded me.

I have not arrived.

And perhaps that is the point.

Growth means there is still more to become.

I am still learning.

Still dreaming.

Still building.

Still becoming.

And if there is one thing I want you to take from my story, it is this:

Never kill a dream simply because its time has not yet come.

The seed does not look like the tree.

The beginning does not look like the destination.

And the person you are today may not resemble the person you will become tomorrow.

Keep going.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Sir Rodney Wafula Simiyu, known as Sir Rodney, was born in Kamukuywa Ward, Kimilili Constituency, Bungoma County, Kenya.

His early education journey began in schools around Kamukuywa. He attended Friends Kimalewa Primary School, where he completed his primary education and sat for the KCPE examination in 2017.

In 2018, he joined Chesamisi Boys School, where he continued his secondary education and completed his KCSE examinations in March 2022.

His journey later led him to Mount Kenya University, where he began his university education in September 2024, pursuing Information and Communication Technology.

But Sir Rodney's story is more than a list of schools and dates.

It is a story of growth.

It is a story of a young man who experienced changes he did not choose, faced circumstances he did not expect, encountered disappointment, experienced rejection, struggled with uncertainty, and still chose to keep moving.

His journey has strengthened his belief in education, leadership, relationships, faith, and the power of dreaming beyond one's circumstances.

Today, he continues to pursue education while nurturing ambitions of becoming a PhD holder, a CEO, a great leader, and an author of more books.

GROWTH is part of that journey.

This book is not the story of someone who had everything figured out.

It is the story of someone who kept becoming.

And perhaps that is the most honest definition of who I am:

I am still growing.

FINAL WORD

If life has taught me anything, it is that the story is rarely finished where we think it is.

There were moments I thought I had reached the end.

I had not.

There were moments I thought I was being left behind.

I was being prepared.

There were moments I thought I was losing everything.

I was learning what truly mattered.

And there were moments I wondered whether my dreams would ever come alive.

Today, I know better.

I will keep dreaming.

Because I have learned that life can change.

People can change.

Circumstances can change.

Doors can open.

And God can take you places you never imagined.

So, wherever you are in your journey, keep walking.

Keep learning.

Keep believing.

Keep dreaming.

Your present circumstances are not necessarily your final destination.

And if one day you look back at your own story, I hope you will be able to say what I can say today:

I did not become who I am because life was easy.

I became who I am because life taught me how to grow.

And the journey is not over.

My growth continues.